122, 1123, respectively; and Ball, Bordeaux et al. 2019: 350–351, 353–360, 376–379.

42. The tandem existence among these differing axes of communication between Central Asia and India – the north–south axis *via* Bamiyan also incorporating the more southerly reaches of Zabul and Zamindawar – nonetheless resurfaced during the Ghaznavid and later periods. Cf. Inaba 2013: 90.
43. Perhaps an exception to this overall emphasis on Buddhist monastic and religious architecture in the contiguous valleys was Kakrak, to the southeast of Bamiyan: here, to the north of the grottoes, a small walled structure (fort?) has been dated to the early phase of Shahr-i Zuhak, i.e., *c.* 500 CE. Cf. Le Berre 1987: 81; Baker and Allchin 1991: 157. For a brief description of Kakrak's Buddhist ritual and monastic remains, see Tarzi, vol. I, 1977: 78. A description of the extremely rich grottoes of Fuladi was provided by Dagens 1964: 43–48, figs. and pls.
44. Cf. Le Berre et al. 1985–1988: 776, 782, 783; Lorain 2018. While Le Berre and others have noted the topographical and architectural parallels between the Bamiyan basin and Ghur – the latter being less clearly defined given the lack of both historical and modern documentation there – they did *not* pursue these observations further, to conclude that in Ghur much of the architectural landscape was reused and repurposed by later populations. Cf. Chapter 2.
45. The Bamiyan valley and specifically the Funduqistan monastery – the valley's only free-standing mud-brick structure (other complexes principally being grottoes of various dimensions) – has offered evidence of Brahmanical–Hindu cultic presence, similar to the coexistence of Buddhist and Brahmanical cults at various sites in the vicinities of Kabul and Ghazna. Worthy of special mention was the exquisite Mahisha-mardini from Funduqistan, preserved only in Durga's multiple arms and zoomorphic demon in marble (now lost). Cf. Bernard and Grenet 1981; Klimburg-Salter 1989: 73–74; Ball 2008: 188–189; Ball 2019: No. 332; and Chapter 2.
46. See Le Berre 1970: 45ff.; Baker and Allchin 1991: 55ff., 99–100; Lee 2006: 243–244; Thomas 2018: 118–119 (brief discussion); Ball 2019: No. 1052; Ball, Bordeaux et al. 2019: 391. Fischer (1969: 344) and Baker and Allchin (1991: 99) proposed that in the Bamiyan structures larger bricks were generally older than smaller ones, the latter likely indicating Islamic-period renovations or consolidations of existing structures. However, brick sizes are notoriously inconsistent, and only serve as a general indication of pre-Islamic or Islamic period construction (W. Ball, pers. comm., April 2018).
47. See esp. Le Berre et al. 1985–1988: 780–781. Centuries-long occupation and repeated renovations were evident at Shahr-i Zuhak itself where, during the Timurid period (fifteenth century), apertures possibly for firearms were created on the perimeter walls. Cf. Baker and Allchin 1991: 99. The virtually uninterrupted use of ancient structures is not unique to the Bamiyan region, also having been noted in Gandhara (Fischer 1969: 359) and widely documented in Sistan. Cf. Fischer 1969: 354; Fischer 1970: 484–485; Fischer 1973: 138, 143.
48. Cf. Baker and Allchin 1991: 35ff., 99. For Ghur, see Chapter 2.